SECTION A – 2 MARKS

Q1. (a)

Human Resource Development (HRD) is a planned and continuous process of developing employees' knowledge, skills, abilities, attitudes and values so that they contribute effectively to organisational objectives and achieve personal growth. In simple words, HRD means improving the abilities and potential of employees for better performance.

Q1. (b)

Outcomes of HRD are the results that the development of people brings. Nationally they are a skilled workforce, employment and economic development; in the organisation they are competent employees, better quality, leaders, satisfaction, lower turnover and effectiveness.

Q1. (c)

1. **Communication and interpersonal skills:** An HRD professional must explain, listen and build good relations with employees at every level.
2. **Coaching and training ability:** He must be able to train, coach and guide employees to learn new skills and grow.

Q1. (d)

HRD climate is the employees' perception of whether their organisation provides an environment that supports learning, development, openness, trust and growth. It is shaped by the general climate, the OCTAPAC culture and the HRD mechanisms of the organisation.

Q1. (e)

1. **Leadership:** The style of the manager or leader strongly influences how employees think and act.
2. **Reward systems:** Employees behave according to the rewards and recognition the organisation gives.

Q1. (f)

Aptitude is a person's natural ability or potential to learn and perform a particular kind of work, such as customer handling, teamwork or problem-solving. It shows how well a person can perform after training, not only what he already knows.

Q1. (g)

Leadership development is the planned process of building the leadership qualities of employees, such as decision-making, communication, team handling and strategic thinking, so that they are ready for managerial roles. It uses training, coaching, mentoring, job rotation and leadership projects.

Q1. (h)

Outbound training (OBT) is training conducted outside the workplace, usually outdoors, through adventure activities, games and group tasks such as trekking, rafting and rope courses. It develops teamwork, leadership, trust, confidence and problem-solving.

Q1. (i)

HRD audit is a systematic review of an organisation's HRD strategies, systems, practices and competencies to find out how well they support business goals. It shows the strengths, gaps and areas where HRD must improve.

Q1. (j)

Mentoring is a long-term relationship in which an experienced senior employee (the mentor) guides, advises and supports a junior employee (the mentee) in his career and personal growth. It helps the mentee learn the culture, gain confidence and develop faster.

SECTION B – 5 MARKS

Q2.

1. **Employees as assets with potential:** The developmental perspective views employees as people whose knowledge, skills and potential can be continuously developed.
2. **Continuous learning:** Learning is a lifelong process; employees keep learning new skills to meet changes in work and technology.
3. **Skill, competency and career growth:** It builds the competencies needed for the present job and plans a career path for future growth.
4. **Leadership development:** It identifies and prepares employees for future managerial and leadership roles.
5. **Organisational learning and long-term growth:** Individual learning spreads across the organisation, so both the employee and the organisation grow in the long run.

Q3.

1. **Improves employee performance:** Training raises the skills, productivity and quality of work.
2. **Adapts employees to technological change:** HRD helps employees learn new technology and digital tools.
3. **Develops leadership capabilities:** It builds a pipeline of future leaders from within the organisation.
4. **Increases motivation, engagement and retention:** Employees who see growth and career development feel valued and are less likely to leave.
5. **Encourages innovation and competitive advantage:** Skilled and learning employees bring new ideas, which keep the organisation ahead of competitors.

Q4.

1. **Performance appraisal:** The systematic assessment of an employee's performance against set standards; it identifies strengths, weaknesses and training needs.
2. **Potential appraisal:** It evaluates an employee's capacity to take up higher-level or future responsibilities, and supports promotion and succession.
3. **Training and development:** Training improves skills for the present job; development prepares the employee for future roles.
4. **Feedback and counselling:** Feedback tells employees how their performance compares with standards; counselling helps them solve performance and career problems.
5. **Career planning and job rotation:** Career planning maps the employee's career path, and job rotation moves him through different jobs to broaden his experience.

Q5.

1. **Motivation:** People learn better when they have a reason to learn, for example to get promoted.
2. **Readiness:** The learner must be mentally and physically ready; a tired or uninterested employee learns little.
3. **Practice and active participation:** Repeated practice and taking part through cases, discussions and role plays make learning stronger than a lecture alone.
4. **Feedback and reinforcement:** Learners need to know what they did right and wrong, and behaviour that is praised or rewarded is repeated.
5. **Meaningfulness and transfer:** Learning should be linked to real work, and what is learned must be applied on the job; only then does performance improve.

Q6.

1. **Vision and clear goals:** A good leader knows where the group must go and gives it a clear direction.
2. **Communication skills:** He explains ideas clearly, listens to others and keeps the team informed.
3. **Decision-making and problem-solving:** He takes timely and sound decisions and handles problems calmly.

4. **Integrity and honesty:** He is fair, keeps his word and sets an example, so followers trust him.
5. **Empathy and team building:** He understands people's feelings, motivates them and builds cooperation in the team.

Q7.

1. **Meaning:** HRD audit is a systematic and comprehensive review of the HRD strategies, structure, systems, practices and competencies of an organisation.
2. **Objectives:** It checks whether HRD supports business goals, finds gaps in HR systems and suggests improvements.
3. **Areas covered:** Recruitment and selection, training and development, performance appraisal, compensation, career and succession planning and employee relations.
4. **Methods:** Interviews, questionnaires, observation, study of records and reports, workshops, and benchmarking against the best organisations.
5. **Benefits:** It shows strengths and weaknesses, improves HR systems, ensures legal compliance and links HRD to business results; for example, an audit may find weak promotion criteria or no training evaluation.

SECTION C – 10 MARKS

Q10.

Planning and appraisal subsystems

1. **Human resource planning:** Forecasting the number and kind of employees needed and making them available at the right time. Example: a bank plans the staff needed for 20 new branches.
2. **Performance appraisal:** Assessing an employee's present performance against standards. Example: a salesperson is rated against his target and his weak presentation skill is identified.
3. **Potential appraisal:** Assessing an employee's capacity for future, higher roles. Example: a good sales executive is assessed through an assessment centre for the sales manager post.
4. **Feedback and performance coaching:** Telling employees how they are doing and helping them improve. Example: a manager guides an employee to structure his reports better.
5. **Career planning:** Mapping a career path and the competencies needed for it. Example: executive → supervisor → branch manager, with training at each step.

Development and support subsystems

6. **Training and development:** Building skills for the present job and the future. Example: training staff on new CRM software, and a leadership programme for future managers.
7. **Succession planning:** Preparing employees to fill key posts when they fall vacant. Example: a deputy manager is groomed to replace the retiring plant head.
8. **Organisation development:** Planned efforts to improve the culture, teamwork and openness of the whole organisation. Example: team-building workshops that build trust and collaboration (OCTAPAC).
9. **Rewards and recognition:** Rewarding desired behaviour and good performance. Example: an 'employee of the month' award, incentives and promotion.
10. **Employee welfare, counselling and HR information system:** Looking after the well-being of employees and keeping HR records that support decisions. Example: health check-ups, counselling services and a digital employee database.

Q11.

How employee behaviour affects effectiveness

1. **Work performance and productivity:** Committed and skilled behaviour gives more output and better quality, which directly raises organisational effectiveness.
2. **Attendance and punctuality:** Regular attendance keeps work on time; absenteeism and late coming reduce output and raise costs.
3. **Cooperation and teamwork:** When employees cooperate across departments, work flows smoothly and goals are reached faster.
4. **Communication:** Open and clear communication reduces mistakes and conflicts and speeds up decisions.
5. **Adaptability to change:** Employees who accept new technology and methods help the organisation grow; resistance slows it down.
6. **Organisational citizenship behaviour:** Employees who do more than their duty, help colleagues and protect the company's name build a strong organisation.
7. **Customer orientation and responsiveness:** Employees who take ownership solve customer complaints quickly, which raises customer satisfaction and sales.

Factors and the role of HRD

8. **Negative behaviour harms effectiveness:** Poor attitude, conflict, fear of blame and frequent job-leaving raise costs and lower performance; high turnover means a constant loss of trained staff.
9. **Behaviour depends on internal and external factors:** Internal factors are personality, perception, attitude, motivation, ability and values; external factors are leadership, culture, climate, rewards, job design and policies.
10. **HRD improves behaviour and results:** Training, feedback, a good HRD climate and fair rewards change behaviour, which leads to better performance and organisational effectiveness. Example: after an HRD programme at a retail company, turnover fell from 24% to 17% and customer satisfaction rose from 76% to 84%.

Q12.

Developing human capacity

1. **Aptitude-based recruitment:** Selecting people not only for qualifications but also for aptitude, such as customer handling, teamwork, adaptability and problem-solving.
2. **Knowledge development:** Product, process and system training (for example CRM training) so that employees know their work fully and can apply it.
3. **Values and ethics:** Workshops on integrity, honesty, fairness, accountability and customer orientation so that targets are not met by unethical means.
4. **Skills of human relations:** Training in communication, listening, empathy, teamwork, negotiation, conflict resolution and emotional intelligence.
5. **Responsiveness:** Giving employees authority and a no-blame climate so that they take ownership and solve problems quickly.

Practices that support it

6. **Loyalty and commitment:** Recognition, career growth, fair pay and mentoring make employees stay and give their best.
7. **Transparency:** Clear appraisal scores, promotion criteria and reward rules build trust and a feeling of fairness.
8. **Leadership development:** Coaching, mentoring, job rotation and leadership projects prepare employees to be promoted from within.
9. **Coaching, mentoring and feedback:** Regular guidance from seniors and managers helps employees correct mistakes and grow faster.
10. **Evaluating HRD:** HR accounting, HR audit, benchmarking, impact assessment and ROI show whether HRD improves business results.